

Section II

20 marks

Attempt Question 2

Allow about 45 minutes for this section

Answer the questions in the Section II Writing Booklet provided. Extra booklets are available if required.

Your answer will be assessed on how well you:

- demonstrate understanding of human experiences in texts
- analyse, explain and assess the ways human experiences are represented in texts
- organise, develop and express ideas using language appropriate to audience, purpose and context

Question 2 (20 marks)

Texts challenge our beliefs about others.

To what extent is this your understanding of your prescribed text?

End of Paper

CAUSE : Individ desires > Indiv image

EFFECT : Beliefs are subverted

LATERAL : True nature of humans

Arthur Miller's play ~~critiques the~~ The Crucible (1953) critiques the idea that individuals are ~~or~~ consistent characters who desire a good collective human experience. By dramatising the 1692 Salem witch trials, Miller reveals that people who seem honest like Proctor and Abigail are often those who are the most deceptive, while people who engage in sin such as John Proctor's adultery can ~~also~~ be the most morally consistent and good actor. As an allegorical reconstruction of McCarthyism's second red scare, a period in which political paranoia drives individuals to become inconsistent and betray their own values, Miller invites the audience to re-evaluate their trust in Authority as Danforth becomes a megalomaniac who desires to maintain his own power rather than serve the community. Thus, Miller reveals that while people craft ~~our~~ beliefs to fit their own narratives their ethical foundation is different to what we expect, ~~less~~ making The Crucible a timeless didactic exploration of the fragility of human beliefs in others.

~~And~~ Miller examines how fear catalyses individuals to prioritise individual safety and power over communal wellbeing, subverting our beliefs to reveal that humans are naturally insecure and become selfish in times of strife. Miller crafts the setting of the town to mirror his own context where ~~HUAC~~ evoked a in the American cold war political climate when the fear of being outed as a communist lead individuals to ~~become~~ become inconsistent and ~~to~~ betray their values. Reverend Parris fearful of becoming an anomaly interrogates Abigail Williams

"There is a fashion in the that is sworn to drive me from my pulpit? Do you not understand that?" in which his ~~irony~~ desperate tone highlights the irony that despite being a reverend he values his own personal image over the value of truth, subverting our beliefs about him, ~~revealing~~ revealing that people ultimately stray from their character when pressured. Challenging our belief that people are consistent. ~~Moreover~~ Similarly, Abigail who is scared of being ostracised for her non-conforming acts threatens the other girls "I will ~~come~~ bring a painful reckoning" constructing her as an antagonist that subverts her innocent facade of her "white name", revealing that ~~even when we~~ even if we believe that people are incapable of evil it does not take much to push them over the line. Cites ~~Core~~ Furthermore, Giles Corey's accusation "This man is killing their neighbours for their land" alludes to the Marxist critique on private property, portraying the Putnams as a symbol of bourgeois greed that exploits the towns proletarian majority, subverting our belief that all people care about others wellbeing and won't exploit them for material gains. Thus, Miller reveals that individuals who seem to be good people can ultimately stray from their public image as they become concerned for their position within society.

Miller portrays ^{injustice of} Danforth's court system in Salem as a symbol of the inherent desire for power, revealing that authority can ultimately become megalomaniacal and preserve their own power over the conditions of the community. This aims to challenge the audience's belief in HUAL by crafting Danforth as a metaphor of institutional authority that mirrors HUAL's ~~own~~ manipulation of the fear of communism to create flawed persecutory mechanisms. Danforth's systemically biased trial is evident in his stage directions where he aggressively interrogates Mary Warren in "his 'first real outburst'" ~~yet significantly softens his~~ juxtaposed against his "weakening" deference towards Abigail Williams, whose testimony serves to validate his authority. This ~~suggests that~~ challenges our beliefs that courts judges are fair arbitrators of justice, ultimately suggesting that they value their own power and reputation over ^{the experience of those} ~~those~~ who enter the court room. Miller reflects this broader societal decay through Herrick who notes that "There be so many cows wandering the high roads now that masters be in the jails" as ironic symbol of the breakdown of social order caused by the courts' allegiance to flawed justice. This reveals that others become blind to the communities suffering when their own position and power come into question. Thus, Miller challenges the audience's faith in the government to provide just outcomes, encouraging them to question their beliefs about McCarthy and HUAL judges.

through acts of defiance, ~~Miller~~ ~~Miller~~ ~~Miller~~
Miller explores how characters undergo acts of
defiance to preserve their own morals, ~~revealing~~
that challenging our belief that survival is
the ultimate goal in life. Miller crafts John
Proctor as his own superhero which he mirrors
in his own confrontation with HVA "My
conscience will not permit me to use the
name of another man" where he asserts
that survival is found not in ~~the~~ physical
world but rather in the maintenance of one's morals.
This is amplified by Proctor crying out in an appeal
to others "Because it is my name! Because
I cannot have another in my life" where
name becomes a metonym for identity, revealing that
individuals find fulfillment in honourably sticking to
their morals rather than staying alive through
deceit. Similarly, Lizabeth chooses to preserve
his children's inheritance in his ~~final~~ ~~words~~
stoic resistance with his final words "more
weight" where he uses laconic diction to
function as a symbolic act of ultimate defiance,
challenging of belief that ~~forcing~~ ~~ones~~ ~~property~~
survival triumphs a loss of inheritance. Miller
~~delivers~~ ~~in~~ continues with John Proctor's final
lament "Now I do think I see some shred of
goodness in John Proctor -- white enough to
keep itself from such days" using the biblical
symbol of white to present himself as purified
challenging the belief that he regrets his
actions sentencing himself to death. This reveals
that ~~Miller~~ By foregrounding the acts of

defiant individuals before death, Miller reveals that people can resist suffering through moral courage, ~~encouraging individuals~~ to challenging the belief that we have to conform when faced with death, encouraging his audience to defy HVAL.

Thus, Miller reveals the true nature of humans as they act inconsistently.

40:00

This challenges our belief that individuals are morally consistent. He also challenges the ~~idea~~ belief that the courts ^{judges} are impartial and want to find the truth. This reveals that through this he breeds distrust in. Furthermore he reveals to audiences that they ~~do not need to resist~~ can resist HVAL. Through this he breeds distrust in the government, encouraging individuals to resist HVAL through defiance and condemn those who selfishly conform.